

Design Over Hype: Building the Agentic AI Supply Chain



Table of Contents

Introduction	3
Part 1: Hype vs. Hope	5
The need for AI-native supply chain	5
A spectrum of AI solutions	5
A crisis for heuristics-based supply chain software vendors.....	6
Enter the generative AI revolution.....	7
The temptation to use GenAI for everything	7
GenAI Problem 1: Variability	8
GenAI Problem 2: Hallucinations	9
Part 2: Coupa AI's Unique Approach	10
AI agents that help users.....	10
Agent profile: Knowledge Management Agent.....	11
Agent profile: Modeling Agent	12
Fast approximate optimizations when needed.....	12
Scenario comparison and results explanation.....	13
Supply chain prescriptions turn AI insights into action	14
Matching AI agents with specific needs	15
Building reliable, AI-native tools	15
Creating mathematically capable GenAI agents.....	16
Determining the accuracy of a chain of agents.....	16
Part 3: Future Vision	17
The human advantage: Where experts fit into an agentic AI supply chain.....	17
From modelers to decision architects.....	17
The design-to-pay differentiator	17
The always-on system.....	18
Where Coupa stands	18

Introduction

Supply chain modeling is the art of the real. As advances in generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) rock the foundation of business software across every industry and new paradigms promise to overtake tried-and-true processes, supply chain modelers are all coming to the same realization:

The decision space is too large for GenAI alone.

GenAI can write poetry, generate images, and perform simple reasoning tasks. But you cannot throw a set of GenAI agents at a real-world supply chain problem and expect them to collectively make the right decisions at scale within any reasonable amount of time or compute cost.

Coupa has been aware of these limitations of GenAI since day one and recent research results are now backing this up. For example, [a recent Apple AI research paper](#) confirms that for large language models (LLMs) and large reasoning models (LRMs) there are three regimes of behavior based on the complexity of the problem that GenAI is presented with.

For low-complexity tasks, standard LLM models outperform LRMs.

For medium-complexity tasks, the additional thinking in LRMs demonstrates advantage.

For high-complexity tasks, both kinds of models experience what they describe as **complete collapse**, meaning the answer that is given is completely wrong, though it is confidently presented to the user as being the correct answer.

When dealing with complex problems like supply chains and two-sided markets, simply throwing a bunch of hierarchical LLM/LRM agents at these large, coupled problems is suboptimal in every sense of the word. There will be high compute costs, slow coordination speeds, and high human manual design, tuning, and maintenance costs.

So while headlines hail a new era of AI-powered business, supply chain leaders face a more grounded challenge: How do you apply AI that reasons in a stochastic or unpredictable way? How do you even establish a baseline for evaluating design or planning decisions when the AI gives you a different baseline every time you run it?

Planning under uncertainty is what supply chain leaders do every day, however the last thing that today's leaders need is to use tools that add **artificial** uncertainty, including the risk of hard-to-detect hallucinations deep in the supply chain optimization processes.

To compound the issue further, generative AI is notoriously bad at simple arithmetic. The transformer architecture (the "T" in ChatGPT) is great for human language where individual word choice in text is interchangeable, but in the economics of supply chain, all product costs must be precise and

accurate. A dollar is worth a dollar regardless of its position in the supply chain.

So real-world supply chain problems require more than generative AI agents. They demand a thoughtfully architected approach for performing decision-making at scale that is trusted and repeatable, without the risk of hallucinations. They should make use of generative AI where it excels, but numerical guardrails need to be thoughtfully placed. AI cannot be a black box, and every AI agent must, by default, be able to explain any decision made.

As real-world supply chain problems compound and global volatility becomes our new normal, companies that operationalize reliable AI solutions now will be the ones best positioned to adapt quickly and win by embracing the exponential improvement that the proper use of AI can bring. Companies or vendors simply throwing GenAI agents at the supply chain will have failed deployments and sink into the [trough of disillusionment](#).

The future lies in balancing generative AI with programmatic and mathematical AI. Success will depend on robust models built on trustworthy data structures, mathematical rigor, and hard-won domain experience.

In this paper, we'll **separate the hype from the hope** and outline the real opportunities and pitfalls of incorporating generative AI into supply chain modeling. You'll learn about the different AI technologies that Coupa uses in their supply chain solutions and how they're solving some of the stickier problems of GenAI in order to prioritize lasting value over fleeting trends.

Part 1: Hype vs. Hope

The need for AI-native supply chain

Supply chain organizations that delay adopting AI risk falling behind competitors who are already using it to streamline operations, cut costs, and accelerate innovation across procurement and supply chain functions.

“Only 17% of supply chain organizations have succeeded in deploying AI at scale.”

Gartner, A CSCO’s Guide to AI Strategy, Noha Tohamy, 2025

AI-native platforms go far beyond automating routine tasks — they offer strategic insights and real-time guidance that help businesses respond faster to change and uncertainty.

These advanced systems help modelers pinpoint key cost drivers, recommend optimized scenarios to reduce costs, and unlock savings more quickly. AI also speeds up complex workflows through intelligent automation, while AI-powered risk assessments proactively identify and mitigate potential supplier disruptions.

Unlike “slapped-on” AI tools that are bolted onto legacy systems, AI-native solutions are built from the ground up with intelligence embedded into their core architecture. That means the data, models, and AI agents are fully integrated — enabling faster decision-making, more accurate recommendations, and a smoother user experience across the entire supply chain platform.

A spectrum of AI solutions

Coupa has been an AI pioneer for years, both in mathematical AI but also in the early use of generative AI in supply chain, long before the debut of ChatGPT and large language models (LLMs). However, Coupa’s supply chain origins were in the field of mathematical programming (also known as mathematical optimization or “solver” engines). Many people see AI and mathematical optimization as very different things, but in fact they have a deep connection.

This less-understood fact is that: All AI and machine learning is essentially an optimization process. Learning from data or text is an iterative optimization process of minimizing the error between the prediction and the correct answer. Optimization is central to all of AI and machine learning, especially the

What makes Coupa Navi™ AI different?

Patent-pending hallucination mitigation

Automated AI agent assembly

Domain-specific expertise

Integration with procurement and finance

Community of 10 million buyers and suppliers

use of reinforcement learning in training AI foundation models.

The lens of optimization is also useful for designing methods to combine generative agentic systems, human users, and mathematical agents so they all work together to optimize the overall objectives of the supply chain without hallucination.

Coupa has been researching this unification of learning and optimizing systems in order to bring the best of both worlds.

A crisis for heuristics-based supply chain software vendors

In contrast, some supply chain software vendors base their supply chain modeling approach on human-written heuristics, avoiding mathematical solvers. Heuristic approaches are not optimizations (there is no objective function or goal) and the heuristics often only find feasible solutions that satisfy some constraints.

The existential question for these vendors is: How can a heuristic approach be aligned with the objectives of AI and the user? The simple answer is: It cannot. So instead, these vendors muddy the waters and call themselves vendors of supply chain “orchestration” solutions which are inevitably expensive, unstable, and difficult to maintain. They deliver suboptimal business results and require manual inputs from users that are already under pressure.

A criticism of mathematical optimization approaches in the past has been that mathematical solvers take too long to find solutions. The Coupa supply chain design and planning solution has long employed several optimization techniques such as linear and mixed-integer programming, stochastic optimization, and constraint programming.

However, Coupa now has fast-approximate mathematical methods that allow a user to trade off compute time against accuracy.

Optimization can now be delivered at the speed of heuristics while still keeping the AI agents aligned with the business.

Coupa is also researching new fast approximate algorithms using AI. This opens an exciting new field of user experience and business benefits.

Together these capabilities allow for the creation of high-fidelity digital twins that accurately model real-world constraints, including sourcing limitations, sustainability goals, and capacity constraints. When combined with Coupa’s simulation capability, they form the basis of the next generation of supply chain design and planning software.



Coupa's deep expertise in combining multiple forms of AI including machine learning, deep learning, and reinforcement learning all fit into this objective-driven framework. A real-time engine manages the supply and demand of the AI compute resources themselves.

Users of the system don't have to be concerned about the details of the underlying technology because the mathematics make it all explainable. This ensures you get answers within the accuracy and time frame needed with a minimal AI compute cost.

Enter the generative AI revolution

Generative AI is an advanced class of artificial intelligence that can create entirely new content — ranging from text and images to numerical data, video, and audio — based on patterns it has learned from training data. Best known to the public through tools like ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, and Google Gemini, generative AI isn't new, but it has recently reached a tipping point in usability and accessibility.

What once required deep technical expertise can now be accessed through natural language interfaces, allowing users across industries to generate reports, draft content, simulate data, and even design product concepts in seconds. As adoption accelerates, businesses are racing to understand where generative AI adds value — and where its probabilistic nature may fall short in high-stakes environments like supply chain optimization.

The temptation to use GenAI for everything

As generative AI gains momentum, new software vendor companies entering the supply chain optimization space — many without mature or proven solutions — may be tempted to apply it indiscriminately.

Faced with messy or incomplete data, these vendors might default to large language models (LLMs), hoping the AI can clean the data, build a custom model, and optimize the supply chain all in one sweep — either with an LLM or LRM directly as optimizer or through LLM or LRM agents interacting with a solver.

Coupa considers these “toy” scale models. They look good and give users the impression of usefulness. But when applied at real-world scales, they break.

There is an enormous mismatch between models that can be generated quickly in a demo environment using GenAI and a robust, realistic supply chain model. It's a major “watch-out” for supply-chain modelers.

There are two major problems with this approach.

“Generative AI is not the primary AI approach for inventory optimization, sales forecasting, on-shelf availability, predictive maintenance, autonomous systems and robotics or claims management and repair.”

Gartner, Choose fit-for-purpose AI methods to achieve your supply chain objectives, Noha Tohamy, 2025



GenAI Problem 1: Variability

Reliable supply chain models need to be deterministic. When given a data set and asked a question, they should return the same model and the same solution every time.

LLMs are stochastic — they don't guarantee the same answer twice.

Generative AI will create a different model and optimization solution every time it is presented with a problem, even when using the exact same data. When new models are generated every time they are presented with a data set, you cannot compare scenarios against a standard baseline, so selecting a best scenario becomes impossible.

Deterministic

Follows fixed rules.

Same inputs = same outputs.

Stochastic

Uses statistical reasoning to make predictions.

Different outputs every time.

In supply chain design, where models are complex and decisions are high stakes, that's a dealbreaker. You need deterministic, repeatable outputs to build trust, ensure consistency, and form a learning foundation.

Generative AI tools excel at summarizing unstructured text, but they don't know how to consistently turn that data into something you can actually compute on. Supply chain design requires structured data, clean assumptions, and a precisely defined mathematical model. That's why a purpose-built solution in the middle that standardizes data with a defined schema helps to get a more deterministic output.

GenAI Problem 2: Hallucinations

Many of us have experienced hallucinations firsthand when using ChatGPT and seeing it return incorrect information to us.

For example, you might ask ChatGPT to solve a straightforward math problem like calculating the square root of a large number, or even just adding a list of numbers with varying numbers of decimal places. Incorrect results are confidently returned by the LLM and the user never knows. Missing information required to answer a question is simply “made up” and the result is presented with confidence.

In part, this is because LLMs or LRMs don’t compute anything mathematically, they just generate responses by predicting what should come next based on patterns in their training data.

LLMs predict the next word in a sentence, the next stroke of a digital paintbrush or the next number in a mathematical equation.

You can get a word or a paint stroke wrong without major consequences, but math is math — and it’s not up for debate what the next number should be.

This is exactly the kind of stochastic generation that makes GenAI risky in contexts like supply chain modeling — where facts, calculations, and consistency matter.

As Alan McCord, Principal Data Scientist for Coupa Supply Chain Design & Planning says, *“Large language models are amazing at language, but they’re bad at math.”*

And mathematical hallucinations have no place in a useful supply chain model.

Part 2: Coupa AI's Unique Approach

Coupa Navi™ is an AI-native platform that uses machine learning, deep learning, and reinforcement learning AI to power dependable, robust processes. Generative AI helps users understand their supply chain model and compare scenarios and answer ad hoc questions facilitating natural language communication between the user and the system.

Rather than relying on stochastic, general-purpose AI models, Coupa is building an agentic architecture rooted in accuracy, transparency, and domain-specific design.

Insights are surfaced. And user prompts are translated into powerful instructions that make solving faster, more accurate, and easier to report on.

AI agents that help users

Coupa Navi™ is an agentic AI system, where specialized agents of different types autonomously handle specific tasks based on their unique and combined capabilities.

AI agents are autonomous software programs designed to perform specific tasks on behalf of users. These agents are designed to solve one of the biggest problems in enterprise software: the burden placed on users to manually interpret data, identify next steps, and execute actions across disconnected systems.

Instead of requiring users to hunt for insights or stitch together processes, AI agents proactively surface recommendations, automate workflows, and guide users through complex decisions.

Agentic AI systems are not just reactive or single-use — they pursue a goal over time, adjusting their behavior based on feedback.

Coupa Navi™ AI agents are a blend of multiple types of AI

Generative AI for limited-scale subject matter reasoning (e.g., translating user intent to prepare optimization models)

Mathematical AI for large-scale reasoning (e.g., selecting the best shipping route given constraints)

Reinforcement learning to learn how to solve models better over time

But unlike general AI, agentic AI operates within **defined parameters** — constraints, rules, objectives, and goals — set by human designers. This ensures agentic AI stays aligned with business objectives, risk thresholds, and ethical standards.

User inputs flow through an orchestration layer that intelligently routes requests to the right agent — or a coordinated team of agents — for execution and determines when a request cannot be answered or whether to ask the user for more clarification.

Where Coupa Navi™ shines is in its domain-expertise and native integration within Coupa's supply chain modeling solutions. AI agents help users get accurate predictions, prescriptive recommendations, and progress from automation to autonomy as they help them analyze their supply chains and make informed decisions.

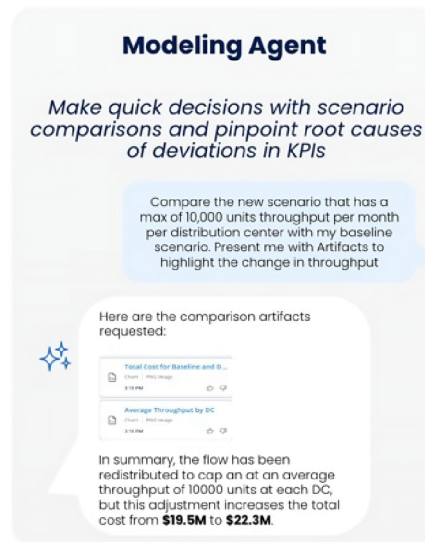
Agent profile: Knowledge Management Agent

Accelerate onboarding and scale your supply chain modeling teams faster with AI-powered guidance and search across the Supply Chain Design & Planning (SCDP) product suite. Instantly get answers about how to model the supply chain and configuration best practices — continuously enriched with the latest features and product updates — so your teams always have the most current information at their fingertips.



Agent profile: Modeling Agent

Empowers supply chain leaders to make faster, smarter supply chain decisions to manage disruptions and confidently strike an optimal balance across business KPIs (cost, service, sustainability, and risk). The modeling agent does this by generating intelligent scenario summaries that highlight key insights, uncover root drivers, and clarify trade-offs behind each potential supply chain change.



Example: GenAI agents can run scenarios in the background to surface useful prescriptions that save time and money while reducing risk.

Fast approximate optimizations when needed

One of the most persistent challenges in supply chain modeling is that solve times can vary widely based on a range of factors, including the number of locations and products, the granularity of the data, and the mathematical complexity of the model itself. As models scale in size and sophistication, computational efforts can expand exponentially.

But beyond these technical challenges lies an operational one: time pressure. It's not uncommon for modelers to receive a last-minute request from leadership: "Can we get a scenario analysis in two hours?" When that happens, the ability to estimate and strategically manage time-to-solve becomes essential.

This is where knowing your tools, and their trade-offs, makes a difference. For example, a modeler may choose to use a fast heuristic like RNE (Rapid Network Explorer) to generate a directional answer quickly. In other cases, particularly when high-stakes decisions are being made, it may be worth investing the time to run a full optimization that captures every nuance of the scenario.

AI has the potential to dramatically enhance how users interact with complex supply chain challenges like these by augmenting them with real-time intelligence. By analyzing historical and real-time data, a machine learning model can actively guide the solving process given the target accuracy and time

limit requirements expressed by the user, automatically. For example, a user might be presented with the option to run a full optimization that takes longer but yields the most precise result, or to execute a partial solve that delivers a quicker, “good-enough” answer for directional decision-making.

In practice, this allows users to work more iteratively and efficiently. Instead of waiting for a single exhaustive solve, they can use faster, lower-fidelity runs to explore broad solution spaces and eliminate nonviable options with control logic monitoring in the background.

Users “prune the tree” as they narrow in on high-value scenarios worth deeper analysis. It’s a smarter way to model: faster answers when you need them, and full optimization when it matters most.

Key takeaway: Approximate solves can pack a lot of value. But don’t be confused by startups that do partial solves powered by GenAI and call them full optimizations.

Scenario comparison and results explanation

Modelers need scenario comparison because real-world supply chain decisions almost never have one obvious answer. Instead, modelers are constantly evaluating trade-offs between cost, service levels, risk exposure, and sustainability.

Every supply chain decision involves competing priorities — faster vs. cheaper, centralized vs. distributed, local vs. global. Navi helps modelers interact with the results of solved scenarios by surfacing the critical differences and trade-offs with maximum impact.

A supply chain modeler might be asked to run a scenario comparing sourcing material in Mexico vs. the U.S. The results show that sourcing in Mexico costs \$700,000 more — but why?

Navi can:

- Provide a **tabular breakdown** of where results differ
- Explain outcomes in **natural language** with concise answers and summaries
- **Visualize results** with charts that help illustrate scenario differences

Navi goes beyond just presenting outcomes, it provides intelligent diagnostics to explain why results changed. By analyzing input variations, constraints, and model assumptions, Navi highlights the key drivers behind shifts in performance metrics. This enables teams to pinpoint root causes, validate assumptions, and refine models.

And because Navi is adept at natural language, you can ask it to explain scenario differences to distinct personas. “Navi, please explain this to me as if I am the CFO of our company.”

“Navi will help you communicate your story to your stakeholders in the way they will be best able to understand.”

Gaurav Goyal, Director, Product Management, Supply Chain Design & Planning, Coupa

The result? A deeper understanding of supply chain behavior across your organization.

Supply chain prescriptions turn AI insights into action

To make the maximum impact, supply chain modelers need to move from insight to action quickly. Navi proactively recommends supply chain prescriptions to reduce costs, mitigate risk, and optimize network efficiency — unlocking savings that even experienced supply chain planners might miss.

Drawing on a deep understanding of a company's supply chain network — including nodes, lanes, lead times, and costs — Supply Chain Prescriptions leverages machine learning to identify and evaluate alternative strategies. These include switching transportation modes, skipping network nodes and consolidating volumes — all tailored to a company's cost, revenue, and service level goals.

Opportunities identified will include:

Node skipping: Can a shipment go directly from point A to point C, bypassing point B?

Mode switching: Would switching from truck to rail reduce costs or improve reliability?

Volume consolidation: Can smaller, fragmented shipments be combined to drive savings?

These prescriptions rely on cost and transit time estimates, often drawn from generalized metrics like mileage-based cost assumptions. However, the accuracy of these recommendations could improve significantly with broader visibility — such as incorporating anonymized shipment data from across the Coupa customer network. This would enable more precise predictions of real-world transit times and costs, ultimately leading to smarter, more confident decision-making.

Whether the goals are to reduce costs, mitigate risk, or achieve a combination of both, benefit from tailored recommendations and actionable steps to meet supply chain objectives.



“If you had access to real-time information from other customers, you could get a better estimate on lead time and costs, enabling more precise prescriptions.”

Matt Bassett

Applied Research
Senior Manager,
Data Science,
Coupa

Other key capabilities include:

Minimizing transportation costs, in-transit inventory costs, network risk

Estimation of transportation rates for identified opportunities

Identification of cost drivers in the supply chain

Translating opportunities identified by supply chain prescriptions to supply chain modeler

Recommendations for additional sites, additional lanes and rebalanced flows

By surfacing the most promising changes and tying them directly to potential business outcomes, prescriptions help modelers focus their efforts where they'll have the greatest impact. It's not just about automating decisions; it's about **amplifying human judgment** with intelligent suggestions that make modeling faster, more focused, and more effective.

Matching AI agents with specific needs

Which AI agents does a user need? In what order should they be strung together? How are they prompted? And what guardrails and checks keep them from producing errors?

As of today, Coupa is diligently designing and refining their orchestration layer manually. As Coupa Navi™ rolls out to more users, they are carefully observing and optimizing the user/agent dynamic.

As their intelligent router evolves and customers configure their own agents that they'll want to add to the process, their roadmap calls for using AI to dynamically create a framework for specific users, tasks, and their chains of agents.

Building reliable, AI-native tools

Large enterprise businesses with deep technical benches and internal development teams may feel tempted to build their own GenAI-driven supply chain solutions from scratch. While this approach offers control and customization, it also exposes organizations to significant risks — especially when they lack the domain-expertise needed for agentic AI systems and supply chain modeling.

Homegrown solutions often struggle with the same issues plaguing newer market entrants: hallucinated insights, inconsistent model behavior, and lack of integration across functions. Without a stable foundation, these in-house efforts can quickly become expensive science experiments.

In contrast, Coupa offers an AI-native platform where intelligence is embedded at the core — not tacked on as an afterthought. With Coupa Navi™, businesses benefit from a growing framework of specialized AI agents that are deeply integrated with structured data, trusted optimization engines, and real-world domain logic.

Because Coupa has already invested years in building, testing, and scaling AI for enterprise-grade supply chain needs, it offers the fastest and most reliable path to value. Furthermore, the Coupa

research teams are making sure the latest developments, models, and techniques emerging in all types of AI are brought into the Coupa Navi™ framework, so the burden of keeping up with the “firehose” of innovation of AI is done for you — leaving you to focus on your business. No wild goose chase required.

Creating mathematically capable GenAI agents

Coupa’s neuro-symbolic approach to AI has no issue understanding math. It can query, do aggregations, and perform mathematical operations.

Regular GenAI has a hallucination problem that makes its math untrustworthy. Large language models are built to predict the next word in a sequence — a task that is unrelated to math.

But Coupa has a patent-pending solution to this problem that significantly reduces hallucination while maintaining balance between accuracy and efficiency. In fact, the core measures used in the Coupa patent have [recently been validated as key to assessing LLM and LRM capacity by research teams at Meta AI and Google DeepMind](#). Management of reasoning capacity utilization of the LLM/LRM is one of the key concepts of the patent.

Coupa Navi™ is designed to be **trusted AI**. Coupa uses proven tools, innovative GenAI techniques, **and always** shows the work and underlying assumptions to the user.

Determining the accuracy of a chain of agents

Errors compound across a chain of agents and it’s important that both users and the routing systems that push problems across a chain of agents are aware of compounding error rates.

If three agents have an accuracy of 90% each, when used together, their effective accuracy will be 72.9%.

$$0.9 * 0.9 * 0.9 = 0.729$$

Insight into this is essential. As Coupa moves towards “always-on” agents, they are working on a mathematical framework that keeps agents both on task and within acceptable limits for accuracy.

They have patents pending that govern the design of an agentic system that governs agents, delivers value, works quickly, and doesn’t blow up users’ compute budgets.

Key takeaway: Users need to learn the best way to ask questions. When users ask their AI agents high-level questions, they get high-level answers — which can leave a lot of value on the table. As users become comfortable asking more specific questions, they can chain together requests that zero in on opportunities that would be hard to find any other way.

Part 3: Future Vision

The human advantage: Where experts fit into an agentic AI supply chain

As AI agents become more capable — handling optimization tasks, surfacing cost-saving scenarios, and interpreting unstructured data — the natural question arises: Where do humans fit in?

The answer is simple: **at the center of it all.**

While next generation agentic AI systems like Coupa Navi™ automate complexity and accelerate analysis, agentic supply chain modeling works hand in hand with human insight, strategic judgment, and contextual understanding. Agents can highlight recommendations and act on them — but it's all in service of helping human experts align their work with organizational priorities and operational constraints.

From modelers to decision architects

In an agentic system, the role of the supply chain professional evolves. Rather than spending time cleaning spreadsheets or manually testing dozens of scenarios, modelers can shift their focus to higher-value work like **interpreting trade-offs** when the system presents multiple optimization paths, **aligning decisions** with financial and procurement goals and **governing agentic behavior** through accuracy thresholds.

Agentic AI amplifies human expertise. It handles the mechanical and mathematical burden so that practitioners can focus on what they do best: making decisions in uncertain, dynamic environments. Their domain expertise enables them to accurately assess and interpret the recommended outcomes — understanding not just what the model suggests, but why it matters and how to act on it in context.

The design-to-pay differentiator

Coupa Navi™ isn't just another AI tool, it's a supply chain copilot built on a platform that spans supply chain modeling, procurement, and finance.

“Coupa lowers the barrier of entry for a larger group of people within our organization — they don't need to have a Ph.D. in operations research to be able to use the product and come up with a solution. And getting to the solution in real-time, that's quite a significant impact.”

Robert Wang

Principal, Supply Chain Optimization, Nestlé



Unlike disconnected point solutions, Navi ensures that every input, recommendation, and report aligns with financial goals and sourcing constraints.

Coupa's two-sided network of over 10 million buyers and suppliers creates a data ecosystem that's impossible to replicate with startup tools or homegrown systems. As more users run models and solve supply chain problems, the platform learns. Without ever sharing data, Navi compounds insight across the community, so each new solve builds on the ones before it.

Beyond internal modeling, Navi connects to external market signals in real time. Trade policies, tariffs, geopolitical events, and freight rate fluctuations are all accounted for without the user needing to gather and cleanse external data.

Coupa is also democratizing supply chain design by making it accessible to procurement and finance professionals as well as modelers. Simplified workflows, intuitive guidance, and AI agents help every team member, new or experienced, to make smarter decisions faster.

Coupa's roadmap is built for transformation. As the data set Navi accesses expands from user models to community data, estimates for the time and cost of moving materials will gain accuracy, leading to better prescriptions and even suggestions for alternative suppliers

The always-on system

One of the ultimate goals of Coupa Navi™ is to perfect a chain-of-agents approach that can achieve always-on status. Within a user-set compute budget, Navi agents will stay abreast of real-time updates to prices, logistics, weather events, and demand patterns — constantly solving for optimization while delivering valuable prescriptions to their users.

Where Coupa stands

In a tech environment transfixed by flashy GenAI demos and “move fast and break things” startup culture, Coupa stands apart.

Coupa remains firm in its belief that real-world supply chain modeling demands mathematical rigor, well-structured data, and deterministic algorithms blended with thoughtfully architected GenAI.

By evolving proven tools, investing in trustworthy GenAI techniques, and transparently showing their work to users, Coupa is building the agentic supply chain design of the future. No hype train required.

Coupa believes the best way to prepare for the future is by designing it boldly, fearlessly, and responsibly.

Design over hype. Always.

About Coupa

Coupa is the leader in AI-native total spend management. Using its trusted, community-generated, \$8 trillion dataset, Coupa brings autonomous AI agents, a network of 10M+ buyers and suppliers, and leading apps together on one unified platform to seamlessly automate the buying process and connect to customers in a whole new way. With Coupa, you'll make margins multiply™. Learn more at coupa.com and follow us on [LinkedIn](#) and [X \(Twitter\)](#).

